David Khanh Lafond

Product Designer

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Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology **Aug 2024 – Jan 2026**
Masters of Architecture, School of Architecture and Planning (Full Ride Fellowship) *Cambridge, MA*
- Certificate in Product Management, Sloan School of Management
- Rejected offer from Harvard University Graduate School of Design

McGill University **Aug 2020 – May 2023**
Bachelor of Science in Architecture with Distinction, Faculty of Engineering, GPA: 3.91/4.00 *Montréal, QC*
- Computational Design Exploratory Research Assistant
- 8+ Academic & Design Awards

Experience

Tekuma **Jan 2022 – Present**
Senior Designer *Montréal / Rotterdam / Dubai*
- Lead creative direction of smart-city masterplans from concept to delivery across projects in China, the Middle East, and Africa.
- Led final design delivery for *Jumeirah Central*, a $20B mixed-use development in Dubai, coordinating across international teams.
- Built *Tekuma Intelligence*, a Claude-powered design system automating branding pitch materials, cutting production time by 60%.
- Co-developed an AI visualization workflow for rapid prototyping and client feedback. [Medium]

Fluid Interfaces **Mar 2025 – Sep 2025**
Lead Product Designer *Cambridge, MA*
- Led end-to-end product design for *RE:SELF*, a multimodal voice-journaling app with engineers, researchers, and therapists.
- Facilitated weekly design sprints for a 4-person UX team, translating research and user feedback into product decisions.
- Co-authored a 20-user study in which structured experience improved coping flexibility, leading users to create and implement nearly 2× more weekly action plans for self-driven behavioral change. [CHI '26 paper]

Pumba **Jan 2025 – Mar 2025**
Product Manager *Cambridge, MA*
- Led product discovery for expansion from P2P parking app into B2G market, conducting and synthesizing 12 interviews with city planners to uncover pain points, validate opportunity, and define requirements for a city-government dashboard.
- Translated customer research into product strategy and UX, defining core parking and loading-zone metrics, prioritizing dashboard features, and leading the design of an actionable data experience for municipal decision-makers.

MIT Senseable City **Sep 2024 – Jan 2025**
Lead Product Designer *Cambridge, MA*
- Designed and shipped *Global Interiors*, an interactive data experience translating computer-vision analysis of 640,000+ Airbnb images across 80 cities into accessible visual stories, iterating through rapid prototypes and critiques with computer scientists.

Personal Projects

David's Journal **Mar 2025 – Present**
YouTube Partner *Montréal, QC*
- In 12 months, grew an independent design channel on YouTube from 0 to 9K+ subscribers and 35K+ monthly viewers, generating 340K+ views and 4.4M impressions from 38 videos while studying at MIT.
- Grew a private design community to 700+ members, teaching original courses that generated $6K+ in revenue within first 6 months.

EcoFabriq **Oct 2024 – Jan 2025**
Lead Product Designer *Cambridge, MA*
- Co-designed and built *EcoFabriq*, an AI-powered marketplace connecting fashion designers with sustainable biomaterials, winning First Prize at the MITdesignX × Politecnico di Milano 24-hour Hackathon.
- Selected for the MIT Arts Startup Incubator '25 cohort; conducted 50+ discovery interviews across the fashion and textile supply chain to validate industry pain points, refine the product, and pitch at Demo Day.

Cellar Architectural Journal **Jul 2021 – Jan 2024**
Co-Founder & Editor-in-Chief *Montréal, QC*
- Co-founded and led an 8-person independent annual design publication comprised of undergrads, grads, and postgrads.
- Shipped two digital–print issues and built a community at McGill around the publication through 12+ design lectures and events.

Skills

Design: Figma, Framer, Mobile & Web Product Design, Interaction Design, User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping
Research: Interviews, Surveys, Qualitative Synthesis, MAXQDA, Conjoint Analysis, Sawtooth
Build: HTML/CSS, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Three.js, WebGL, Git, Raspberry Pi, Cursor, Codex, Claude Code
Visual: Adobe Creative Cloud, DaVinci Resolve, Blender, Rhino, Unreal Engine, Motion Design, Data Visualization